

Coin Toss Analysis — Florida vs Alabama



Florida

VS



Alabama

Analysis based on seasons: 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025

What does “first-two-drives” mean?

In this report, a **first-two-drive** refers to the first two offensive possessions that each team receives in a half. These drives are the only ones fully determined by the coin-toss decision:

- The team that **receives** the opening kickoff gets the ball on Drive 1 of the 1st half and Drive 2 of the 2nd half.
- The team that **defers** gets Drive 2 of the 1st half and Drive 1 of the 2nd half.

By isolating just these drives, we remove all possessions influenced by turnovers, special-team anomalies, or game-flow randomness. This creates a clean, apples-to-apples comparison of how possession order affects early scoring opportunities.

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First-Two-Drive Matchup Inputs

This section summarizes each team’s **first-two-drives tendencies**, which are the basis of the coin-toss scenario. These values represent how **Florida** typically starts halves on offense and how **Alabama** typically performs on defense during the same early-drive situations.

Florida vs Alabama Matchup Inputs	
Metric	Value
Florida: Avg Starting Field Position	67.600
Florida: Avg Plays Per First-Two-Drives	7.700
Florida: Avg Drive Yards Gained	32.800
Alabama: Avg Defensive EPA Allowed	0.605

Predicted Scoring Probability

Model Training Context:

These scoring probabilities come from a logistic regression model trained on **SEC vs SEC drives from the 2024–2025 seasons**. Only the **first two drives of each half** were used, ensuring that:

- Possession order is fully determined by the coin toss
- No irregular drives (muffed punts, missing start FP, broken sequences) were included
- Field position, opponent defensive strength, and drive length reflect real SEC tendencies

This ensures that the prediction reflects realistic early-drive performance in comparable SEC matchups.

Using the logistic regression model trained on SEC drive-level data, we estimate the probability that **Florida** scores on their opening possession **under each coin-toss decision**.

Scoring Probability Based on Coin Toss Decision

If Florida RECEIVES:	14.8%
If Florida DEFERS:	20.6%

Recommendation

The model suggests that Florida should DEFER the opening kickoff.

Drive Data Used in This Matchup

Total Relevant Drives Analyzed: 364

Sample of First-Two-Drive Data Involving Florida and Alabama

game_id	half	drive_id	year	week	pos_team	def_pos_team	off_rush_yards	off_pass_yards	drive_yards	def_rush_allowed
401403854	1	4014038541	2022	1	Utah State	Alabama	2	23	25	2
401403854	1	4014038542	2022	1	Alabama	Utah State	3	21	24	3
401403854	2	40140385416	2022	1	Alabama	Utah State	65	0	65	65
401403854	2	40140385417	2022	1	Utah State	Alabama	-1	0	-1	-1
401403857	1	4014038571	2022	1	Florida	Utah	50	14	64	50
401403857	1	4014038572	2022	1	Utah	Florida	0	25	25	0
401403857	2	40140385712	2022	1	Utah	Florida	54	17	71	54
401403857	2	40140385713	2022	1	Florida	Utah	22	32	54	22
401403868	1	4014038681	2022	2	Alabama	Texas	13	53	66	13
401403868	1	4014038682	2022	2	Texas	Alabama	8	64	72	8
401403868	2	40140386812	2022	2	Texas	Alabama	3	0	3	3
401403868	2	40140386813	2022	2	Alabama	Texas	0	-7	-7	0
401403871	1	4014038711	2022	2	Florida	Kentucky	2	16	18	2
401403871	1	4014038712	2022	2	Kentucky	Florida	0	-2	-2	0
401403871	2	40140387116	2022	2	Kentucky	Florida	1	0	1	1
401403871	2	40140387117	2022	2	Florida	Kentucky	1	0	1	1